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The lessons concerning sexual life became more definite. On the one hand, the fatal consequences of pre-marital intercourse were delineated in glaring colours, and warnings were given concerning the female art of seduction and its nature. On the other hand, the proper care of one's own wife during a legitimate pregnancy was inculcated, during which one could retain the goodwill of the ancestors by observing a great number of restrictions. No husband should fail to consider the particular emotional and physiological state of his pregnant wife. Not only should he assist her, for instance, in carrying a load, but he should try to satisfy her idiosyncracies. For example, when a man is warming himself at the fire, he is not to poke in the glowing embers.<sup>2</sup> The explanation given is that, in doing so, he might lay bare a rat which his pregnant wife has taken a fancy to roast, and, by putting her thus to shame, cause her to abort. The teaching regarding pre-marital and extra-marital relations was noteworthy. As reported by Ndetaramo Makule, an apostate of Christianity, it advised neither to fornicate with the betrothed of strangers nor to commit adultery, for both offences would cause a man to lose his property (through paying fines). The special danger of fornication lay in the fact that a male child might be born as the result of such intercourse. The religious notions centring round the first-born son demanded his legitimate birth. But, so the lessons continued, you might have intercourse with old and barren women.

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The safeguarding of the expected child through observing one's kinship obligations requires both a sense of economy and liberality. The lessons stressed the necessity of storing and preserving  food resources. With this they passed over to civic affairs. Manly conduct demands detachment from the female sex and the younger age-groups. For this reason, young men should avoid jesting with their juniors or womenfolk. The only exceptions are the wife of the mother's brother and girls of one's own age, who have been taught not to revile men. The existence among the Chaga of what anthropologists call a joking relationship has never been pointed out. In native educational thought, it is explained as a protection against jokes that might be carried too far and lead to abusive language between two sections which should stand in the relationship of respect and authority to each other.<sup>1</sup> Again, novices were taught not to go with an uninitiated person to a drinking bout, lest in their drunkenness they compromise their manhood and destroy the prestige of their age-group. Their manhood can also be maintained by special food restrictions. It is exhibited by avoiding the eating of the reproductive organs of female cattle, the rectum of all animals,<sup>2</sup> the blood soup (*mlaso*) given to women in confinement, locusts, and the grubs of white ants. All these foods are still eaten by women and uninitiated children only.

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<sup>2</sup> For the symbolic meaning, see p. 180.

<sup>1</sup> The implications are deeper. The joking relationship with young women facilitates the contact of potential marriage partners. The similar relationship with a member of the parental generation, the mother's brother's wife, is a mechanism to counteract the awe of her husband which has been inculcated. Cf. also the fact that the father's sister is called by her personal name, not 'mother'

<sup>2</sup> Natives consider the intestines a relish.

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